

Amorites, The

The Amorites were one of the seven nations of Canaan, governed by many independent kings.

- **Descent and Location:** They were descended from Canaan, the son of Ham. Originally, they inhabited a **mountainous region in the south** but later expanded their territory by conquering land from Moab, east of the Jordan River. Their territory was extensive, encompassing **many strong cities**.

- **Physical Attributes and Character:** The Amorites were described as being of **gigantic strength and stature**, often compared to the height of cedars and the strength of oaks. They were **profane, wicked, and idolatrous**, and their **iniquity** was a reason for their eventual destruction by God.

- **Relationship with Israel:** The Amorites had a **contentious relationship** with the Israelites. They **refused passage** to the Israelites through their land, leading to conflict. God hardened the hearts of the Amorite kings so that they would not allow the Israelites to pass, ultimately resulting in their defeat and the **loss of their eastern territory** to the Israelites. The western Amorite kings also **confederated against Israel** but were miraculously overthrown by God, who cast down great stones from heaven upon them.

- **Other Key Points:**
 - Some Amorites, like Mamre, **joined Abram in his fight against the kings**.
 - The Israelites were **unable to expel all the Amorites** but forced them to become tributaries.
 - During the reign of Solomon, the remaining Amorites were **subjected to forced labor**.
 - The Gibeonites, a tribe of the Amorites, **deceived Israel into a league** by pretending to be from a far country.

- Intermarriage with the Amorites was **condemned** after the captivity.
- The Amorites' **descent** was used to illustrate the **natural state of man**.

The document portrays the Amorites as a powerful but wicked people who God ultimately punished for their iniquity and opposition to the Israelites.

Descent of.

Genesis 10:15-16 And Canaan Begat Sidon his firstborn, and Heth, 16 And the Jebusite, and the Amorite, and the Girgasite,

1 Chronicles 1:13-14 And Canaan Begat Zidon his firstborn, and Heth, 14 The Jebusite also, and the Amorite, and the Girgashite,

One of the seven nations of Canaan.

Genesis 15:21 And the Amorites, and the Canaanites, and the Girgashites, and the Jebusites.

Exodus 3:8 And I am come down to deliver them out of the hand of the Egyptians, and to bring them up out of that land unto a good land and a large, unto a land flowing with milk and honey; unto the place of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites.

Exodus 3:17 And I have said, I will bring you up out of the Affliction of Egypt unto the land of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, unto a land flowing with milk and honey.

Governed by many independent kings.

Joshua 5:1 And it came to pass, when all the kings of the Amorites, which were on the side of Jordan westward, and all the kings of the Canaanites, which were by the sea, heard that the LORD had dried up the waters of Jordan from before the children of Israel, until we were passed over, that their heart melted, neither was there spirit in them any more, because of the children of Israel.

Joshua 9:10 And all that he did to the two kings of the Amorites, that were beyond Jordan, to Sihon king of Heshbon, and to Og king of Bashan, which was at Ashtaroth.

Kings of, great and powerful.

Psalms 136:18 And slew famous kings: for his mercy endureth for ever:

Psalms 136:20 And Og the king of Bashan: for his mercy endureth for ever:

Originally inhabited a mountain district in the south.

Numbers 13:29 The Amalekites dwell in the land of the south: and the Hittites, and the Jebusites, and the Amorites, dwell in the mountains: and the Canaanites dwell by the sea, and by the Coast of Jordan.

Deuteronomy 1:7 Turn you, and take your journey, and go to the mount of the Amorites, and unto all the places nigh thereunto, in the plain, in the hills, and in the vale, and in the south, and by the sea side, to the land of the Canaanites, and unto Lebanon, unto the great river, the river Euphrates.

Deuteronomy 1:20 And I said unto you, Ye are come unto the mountain of the Amorites, which the LORD our God doth give unto us.

Acquired an extensive territory from Moab east of Jordan.

Numbers 21:26 For Heshbon was the city of Sihon the king of the Amorites, who had fought against the former king of Moab, and taken all his land out of his hand, even unto Arnon.

Numbers 21:30 We have shot at them; Heshbon is perished even unto Dibon, and we have laid them waste even unto Nophah, which reacheth unto Medeba.

Had many and strong cities.

Numbers 32:17 But we ourselves will go ready armed before the children of Israel, until we have brought them unto their place: and our little ones shall dwell in the fenced cities because of the inhabitants of the land.

Numbers 32:33 And Moses gave unto them, even to the children of Gad, and to the children of Reuben, and unto half the tribe of Manasseh the son of Joseph, the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, and the kingdom of Og king of Bashan, the land, with the cities thereof in the coasts, even the cities of the country round about.

Of gigantic strength and stature.

Amos 2:9 Yet destroyed I the Amorite before them, whose height was like the height of the cedars, and he was strong as the oaks; yet I destroyed his fruit from above, and his roots from beneath.

CHARACTER OF;

Profane and wicked.

Genesis 15:16 But in the fourth generation they shall come hither again: for the iniquity of the

Amorites is not yet full.

Idolatrous.

Joshua 24:15 And if it seem evil unto you to serve the LORD, choose you this day whom ye will serve; whether the gods which your Fathers served that were on the other side of the flood, or the gods of the Amorites, in whose land ye dwell: but as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD.

Defeated by Chedorlaomer, ect.

Genesis 14:7 And they returned, and came to Enmishpat, which is Kadesh, and smote all the country of the Amalekites, and also the Amorites, that dwelt in Hazezontamar.

Joined Abram against the kings.

Genesis 14:13 And there came one that had escaped, and told Abram the Hebrew; for he dwelt in the plain of Mamre the Amorite, brother of Eshcol, and brother of Aner: and these were confederate with Abram.

Genesis 14:24 Save only that which the young men have eaten, and the portion of the men which went with me, Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre; let them take their portion.

Jacob took a portion from.

Genesis 48:22 Moreover I have given to thee one portion above thy Brethren, which I took out of the hand of the Amorite with my sword and with my bow.

Forbearance of God towards.

Genesis 15:16 But in the fourth generation they shall come hither again: for the iniquity of the Amorites is not yet full.

Doomed to utter destruction.

Deuteronomy 20:17-18 But thou shalt utterly destroy them; namely, the Hittites, and the Amorites, the Canaanites, and the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites; as the LORD thy God hath commanded thee: 18 That they Teach you not to do after all their abominations, which they have done unto their gods; so should ye Sin against the LORD your God.

Refused a passage to Israel.

Numbers 21:21-23 And Israel sent messengers unto Sihon king of the Amorites, saying, 22 Let me pass through thy land: we will not turn into the fields, or into the vineyards; we will not drink of the waters of the well: but we will go along by the king's high way, until we be past thy borders. 23 And Sihon would not suffer Israel to pass through his border: but Sihon gathered all his people together, and went out against Israel into the wilderness: and he came to Jahaz, and fought against Israel.

Deuteronomy 2:30 But Sihon king of Heshbon would not let us pass by him: for the LORD thy God hardened his spirit, and made his heart obstinate, that he might deliver him into thy hand, as appeareth this day.

Deprived of their eastern territory by Israel.

Numbers 21:24-35 And Israel smote him with the edge of the sword, and possessed his land from Arnon unto Jabbok, even unto the children of Ammon: for the border of the children of Ammon was strong. 25 And Israel took all these cities: and Israel dwelt in all the cities of the Amorites, in Heshbon, and in all the villages thereof. 26 For Heshbon was the city of Sihon the king of the Amorites, who had fought against the former king of Moab, and taken all his land out of his hand, even unto Arnon. 27 Wherefore they that speak in proverbs say, Come into Heshbon, let the city of Sihon be built and prepared: ...

Land of, given to Reubenites, ect.

Joshua 13:15-31 And Moses gave unto the tribe of the children of Reuben inheritance according to their families. 16 And their Coast was from Aroer, that is on the bank of the river Arnon, and the city that is in the midst of the river, and all the plain by Medeba; 17 Heshbon, and all her cities that are in the plain; Dibon, and Bamothbaal, and Bethbaalmeon, 18 And Jahazah, and Kedemoth, and Mephaath, ...

Western kings of, confederated against Israel.

Joshua 10:1-5 Now it came to pass, when Adonizedek king of Jerusalem had heard how Joshua

had taken Ai, and had utterly destroyed it; as he had done to Jericho and her king, so he had done to Ai and her king; and how the inhabitants of Gibeon had made peace with Israel, and were among them; 2 That they feared greatly, because Gibeon was a great city, as one of the royal cities, and because it was greater than Ai, and all the men thereof were mighty. 3 Wherefore Adonizedek king of Jerusalem sent unto Hoham king of Hebron, and unto Piram king of Jarmuth, and unto Japhia king of Lachish, and unto Debir king of Eglon, saying, 4 Come up unto me, and help me, that we may smite Gibeon: for it hath made peace with Joshua and with the children of Israel. ...

Miraculous overthrow of.

Joshua 10:11-14 And it came to pass, as they fled from before Israel, and were in the going down to Bethhoron, that the LORD cast down great stones from heaven upon them unto Azekah, and they died: they were more which died with hailstones than they whom the children of Israel slew with the sword. 12 Then spake Joshua to the LORD in the day when the LORD delivered up the Amorites before the children of Israel, and he said in the sight of Israel, Sun, stand thou still upon Gibeon; and thou, Moon, in the valley of Ajalon. 13 And the sun stood still, and the moon stayed, until the people had avenged themselves upon their enemies. Is not this written in the book of Jasher? So the sun stood still in the midst of heaven, and hasted not to go down about a whole day. 14 And there was no day like that before it or after it, that the LORD hearkened unto the voice of a man: for the LORD fought for Israel.

Kings of, degraded and slain.

Joshua 10:24-27 And it came to pass, when they brought out those kings unto Joshua, that Joshua called for all the men of Israel, and said unto the Captains of the men of war which went with him, Come near, put your feet upon the necks of these kings. And they came near, and put their feet upon the necks of them. 25 And Joshua said unto them, Fear not, nor be dismayed, be strong and of good courage: for thus shall the LORD do to all your enemies against whom ye fight. 26 And afterward Joshua smote them, and slew them, and hanged

them on five trees: and they were hanging upon the trees until the evening. 27 And it came to pass at the time of the going down of the sun, that Joshua commanded, and they took them down off the trees, and cast them into the Cave wherein they had been hid, and laid great stones in the Cave's mouth, which remain until this very day.

The Gibeonites a tribe of, deceived Israel into a league.

2 Samuel 21:2 And the king called the Gibeonites, and said unto them; (now the Gibeonites were not of the children of Israel, but of the remnant of the Amorites; and the children of Israel had sworn unto them: and Saul sought to slay them in his zeal to the children of Israel and Judah.)

Joshua 9:3-16 And when the inhabitants of Gibeon heard what Joshua had done unto Jericho and to Ai, 4 They did work wilily, and went and made as if they had been ambassadors, and took old sacks upon their asses, and wine bottles, old, and rent, and bound up; 5 And old shoes and clouted upon their feet, and old garments upon them; and all the bread of their provision was dry and mouldy. 6 And they went to Joshua unto the camp at Gilgal, and said unto him, and to the men of Israel, We be come from a far country: now therefore make ye a league with us. ...

The Israelites unable to expel, but extracted tribute from.

Judges 1:34-35 And the Amorites forced the children of Dan into the mountain: for they would not suffer them to come down to the valley: 35 But the Amorites would dwell in mount Heres in Aijalon, and in Shaalbim: yet the hand of the house of Joseph prevailed, so that they became tributaries.

Had peace with Israel in the days of Samuel.

1 Samuel 7:14 And the cities which the Philistines had taken from Israel were restored to Israel, from Ekron even unto Gath; and the coasts thereof did Israel deliver out of the hands of the Philistines. And there was peace between Israel and the Amorites.

Brought into bondage by Solomon.

1 Kings 9:20-21 And all the people that were left of the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites, which were not of the children of Israel, 21 Their children that were left after them in the land, whom the children of Israel also were not able utterly to destroy, upon those did Solomon levy a tribute of bondservice unto this day.

Ahab followed the abominations of.

1 Kings 21:26 And he did very abominably in following Idols, according to all things as did the Amorites, whom the LORD cast out before the children of Israel.

Manasseh exceeded abominations of.

2 Kings 21:11 Because Manasseh king of Judah hath done these abominations, and hath done wickedly above all that the Amorites did, which were before him, and hath made Judah also to Sin with his Idols:

The Jews after the captivity condemned for intermarrying with.

Ezra 9:1-2 Now when these things were done, the Princes came to me, saying, The people of Israel, and the priests, and the Levites, have not separated themselves from the people of the lands, doing according to their abominations, even of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Jebusites, the Ammonites, the Moabites, the Egyptians, and the Amorites. 2 For they have taken of their daughters for themselves, and for their sons: so that the holy seed have mingled themselves with the people of those lands: yea, the hand of the Princes and rulers hath been chief in this trespass.

Descent from, illustrative of man's natural state.

Ezekiel 16:3 And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD unto Jerusalem; Thy birth and thy nativity is of the land of Canaan; thy Father was an Amorite, and thy mother an Hittite.